

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and experience across the City of Toronto, Metrolinx and Mott MacDonald. Reviews development proposals for their effect on existing and planned infrastructure, coordinates across agencies whose priorities conflict, and writes the memos and briefing notes that carry issues and recommendations to management.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review development applications, engineering submissions and consultant drawings for their effect on existing and planned infrastructure, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Write the memos, briefing notes and presentations that carry plans, issues and recommendations to management across divisions.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing reports rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, holding the schedule and quality myself.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that work on an operating railway imposes, including how far the effect carried beyond the affected subdivision.
- Put the evidence in front of schedulers, operations staff and engineers, and worked with them to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Stakeholder coordination and consensus building across agencies. Development review and infrastructure impact assessment. Memos, briefing notes and presentations for management. Project scoping and follow-through. OpenTrack, VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS and QGIS. Dashboards and performance reporting.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)